

Curriculum Vitae

Thorsten Scherf

Personalia

Name: Thorsten Scherf

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Professional Summary

Customer obsessed long-term Red Hatter with a demonstrated track record of facilitating customer success through resolving intricate issues and tackling high-priority challenges in customer production environments. Expert in fostering collaboration between customer, engineering and product teams to effectively address business requirements within a framework of mutual respect, trust and long-term relationship. Proficient in implementing agile methodologies by leveraging collaborative teamwork, iterative development, and continuous improvement to deliver high-quality software products efficiently.

Work Experience

Sr. Principal Product Operations Engineer
Portfolio Life Cycle Management

Red Hat, 12/2024 – present

In this role my focus is on streamlining processes and driving operational efficiency. Passionate about bridging the gap between product development and customer experience, I specialize in optimizing workflows, enhancing product quality, and ensuring seamless operational support. I'm known for my analytical skills and collaborative approach, I'm dedicated to supporting cross-functional teams to deliver high-impact solutions that meet both business and customer needs.

Technical Writer & Author
Professional IT Publishing Experience

Freelance, 03/2004 - present

Experienced freelance technical writer and author with over 20 years of continuous publication for leading IT and technology magazines. Regular contributor to professional technical publications and author of a long-running monthly column in a well-known IT magazine. Specialized in explaining complex technical topics - such as software engineering, infrastructure, platforms, and emerging technologies - in a clear, precise, and practitioner-oriented manner. Trusted by editors and publishers for reliable delivery, editorial independence, and high technical accuracy. Combines deep hands-on technical expertise with strong editorial judgment, making advanced technologies accessible and relevant to professional audiences.

Sr. Principal Product Experience Engineer
Portfolio Life Cycle Management

Red Hat, 09/2020 – 11/2024

As part of the Product Experience organization, I serve as the Product Lead for our Identity Management and Platform Security products. In this role, I represent customer and support delivery interests within a global, cross-functional team at the technical product level. I collaborate closely with Product and Program Management, Product Owners, Software Engineers, and Documentation Writers to deliver exceptional customer experiences at scale.

Sr. Principal Software Maintenance Engineer
Global Support Services

Red Hat, 01/2016 – 08/2020

In this role, I investigate and troubleshoot complex customer issues and develop custom solutions while understanding business needs. I exceed customer expectations by providing outstanding customer service, proactively updating our customers, and ensuring their satisfaction with our support services.

Sr. Technical Account Manager,
Strategic Customer Engagements

Red Hat, 03/2014 - 12/2015

In this role, I act as a trusted advisor for several top-priority customers. Beyond addressing critical customer issues, I also provide proactive advice and guidance to help my customers identify and address potential problems before they occur. By leveraging my deep understanding of their unique business needs and challenges, I ensure they maximize the value of our solutions and maintain optimal performance. My

goal is to build strong, lasting relationships with these customers, ensuring their long-term success and satisfaction with our services.

Principal Consultant
Global Professional Services

Red Hat, 09/2009 – 02/2014

In this role, I specialize in Infrastructure, Virtualization, and Cloud consulting projects for Red Hat EMEA. I lead teams of 2-5 Red Hat consultants and engage in projects for large enterprise customers throughout the EMEA region. My role encompasses providing expert guidance in technical design, architecture, and project management. I am dedicated to ensuring our team delivers high-quality solutions that effectively address customer requirements and adhere to Red Hat's standards.

Previous Work Experience

Senior Consultant / Instructor

Red Hat, 2004 - 2009

Technical Consultant / Instructor

GfN Group, 2001 - 2004

Linux Network Administrator

University of Essen, 1999-2000

Skills & Competencies

- Client centric mindset
- Developing Strategic Partnerships
- Promoting Cross-Departmental Collaboration
- Crafting Customer Engagement Strategies
- Workshop and training facilitation
- Conference speaker
- Curious Learner

Education

Postgraduate Professional Education, 2000-2001, Essen
System Engineer for heterogeneously networks

University of Essen, 1997-2000
Business informatics

Certificates

- **Product Operations** - Core
- **Prince2** – Foundation Level
- **ITILv3** – Foundation Level
- **TOGAF** – Foundation Level
- **RHCSS #2 WW** – Red Hat Certified Security Specialist
- **RHCA #9 WW** – Red Hat Certified Architect
- **RHCE** – Red Hat Certified Engineer
- **RHCX** – Red Hat Certified Examiner
- **LPIC-1/2** – Linux Junior/Intermediate Level Administrator
- **MCSE** – Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer, Specialization Security, Early Archiver
- **MCSA** – Microsoft Certified Systems Administrator, Specialization Security, Early Archiver
- Several **Red Hat Rewards** for demonstrating commitment to **Red Hat's Values and Culture**

Miscellaneous

- Member of German Amateur Radio Club, licensed since 1990 as DK8EL
- Maintainer of several Software packages in the Fedora repository
- Frequent contributor of technical articles to various international IT magazines
- Fluent in German (native Speaker), English and Esperanto